

▶ REVERSE APPLIQUÉ

This technique uses two or more layers of fabric, cutting away the top layers to reveal the fabric beneath. The raw edges are turned under to finish the shape. Floral, pictorial, and geometric designs work well.

REVERSE APPLIQUÉ BY HAND



1 Choose two fabrics and pin or tack them together, right sides up, around the outside edge. Trace the motif onto a template and cut it out. Place the template right side up on top of the fabric and with a water-soluble pen, trace around the template. (We have used a pencil so that readers can see the lines easily.)



2 Remove the template and tack around the outline approximately 1 cm ($\frac{3}{8}$ in) from the outside edge.



3 Using small, sharp scissors, begin cutting away the shape 6mm ($\frac{1}{4}$ in) inside the marked line, being careful to cut only the top layer of fabric. Cut one section at a time, clipping or cutting small notches into any curves, peaks, or valleys (see p.111).



4 Turn under the seam allowance along the marked line. Using thread to match the top fabric, slip stitch the edge in place.



5 Remove all of the tacking stitches.